

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** C

Options: A) Evangelicalism; B) Pietism; C) Pentecostalism; D) Fundamentalism

Note: Pentecostalism is characterized by its belief in the baptism of the Holy Spirit and the practice of speaking in tongues as a sign of spiritual empowerment and connection with God.

2. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Buddhism; B) Hinduism; C) Judaism; D) Islam

Note: Buddhism, like Jainism, originated in the context of ancient Indian society as a response to the prevailing religious practices, emphasizing renunciation and the pursuit of spiritual liberation from worldly attachments.

3. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Peter; B) Paul; C) Jesus; D) Matthew

Note: Rome claimed that their bishop (pope) was the direct successor of Peter because Peter is considered the first pope and a foundational figure in Christianity, establishing the authority of the papacy in the early Church.

4. **Answer:** C

Options: A) Anglican; B) Catholic; C) Orthodox; D) Lutheran

Note: Icons are a main feature of the Orthodox Church because they are used as sacred images that play a vital role in Orthodox worship and theology, representing the divine and facilitating the connection between the worshippers and God.

5. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Ultimate Reality; B) The gurus; C) The community; D) Sikh worship

Note: The Mul Mantar is a foundational statement in Sikh scripture that encapsulates the essential attributes of God, thereby illuminating the nature of Ultimate Reality in Sikhism.

True / False

6. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Bodu Bala Sena is considered an activist and militant organization in Sri Lanka because it actively promotes Buddhist nationalism and has been involved in various protests and confrontations that have led to violence against minority communities.

7. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Feast of Aphrodite was not the primary festival dedicated to women in ancient Greek cities; instead, festivals such as the Thesmophoria, which specifically honored Demeter and were exclusively for women, held greater significance in celebrating women's roles in society.

8. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Gemarah is primarily a component of the Talmud that discusses Jewish law and ethics, while the primary text of Kabbalah is the Zohar, which focuses on mystical interpretations of Jewish teachings.

9. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The term 'Svetambara' actually means 'white-clad,' referring to a sect of Jainism that wears white robes, in contrast to the 'Digambara' sect, whose members practice extreme asceticism and are known for their nudity.

10. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Guru Nanak and his successors incorporated specific Sikh Ragas into their teachings and hymns to create a musical framework that not only enhances spiritual expression but also fosters a sense of community and harmony among their followers.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** The Babylonian captivity, which began in 586 BCE, was significant because it marked a pivotal moment in Jewish history that profoundly shaped Jewish identity, culture, and religious practices. During this period, many Jews were exiled to Babylon, leading to a loss of their homeland and the destruction of the First Temple in Jerusalem. This experience fostered a sense of unity among the Jewish people, as they sought to maintain their religious traditions and cultural heritage in a foreign land. The captivity also encouraged the development of new religious texts and interpretations, ultimately contributing to the formation of Judaism as we know it today. As a result, the Babylonian captivity played a crucial role in reinforcing Jewish identity and laying the groundwork for future generations.

Note: correct because it emphasizes the Babylonian captivity's role in unifying the Jewish people through the preservation of their identity, culture, and religious practices in the face of exile and loss, which were pivotal in shaping their historical narrative.

12. **Answer:** The "Flower Sermon" is a pivotal moment in Chan-Zen Buddhism that illustrates the essence of enlightenment. In this sermon, Buddha held up a flower and remained silent, which prompted the monk Mahakasyapa to smile, signifying an understanding that transcended words. This event highlights the importance of direct

experience and intuition in achieving enlightenment, rather than relying solely on scriptures or teachings. The significance of the Flower Sermon lies in its emphasis on the non-verbal transmission of wisdom, which is central to Chan-Zen practices, encouraging practitioners to seek their own understanding of reality. Ultimately, it impacts how enlightenment is perceived, suggesting it is an innate realization rather than a goal to be achieved through conventional means.

Note: The answer correctly identifies the "Flower Sermon" as a key moment in Chan-Zen Buddhism that emphasizes the importance of direct, non-verbal experience and intuition in understanding enlightenment, as demonstrated by Mahakasyapa's smile in response to Buddha's silent gesture.

End of Answer Key